VIBECODING 101

Free course

# Duolingo for Claude Code

Claude Code for people who are scared of Claude Code.

8 units | 7 days | 10 minutes a day

You will not write a line of code.
You will not read a line of code.
You will not break anything.



Learn it the way you'd learn Spanish. One word at a time.

**How to AI**

# Read this page or nothing else works

Most Claude Code guides open with an install screen, a terminal window and four configuration steps you don't understand yet, and somewhere around step 3 you close the tab and go back to whatever you were doing.

Duolingo starts you on one word. **El niño.** You get it right in 10 seconds and you keep going.

This guide copies that. You'll do something real on page 4, before you understand any of it.

## The four fears, answered now

### "I'll break my computer."

**You won't.** Claude only touches one empty folder you make in 30 seconds. It can't reach anything else on your machine.

### "I'll spend $2,000 by accident."

**You won't.** $20 a month is a hard ceiling. You run out, it stops, you wait. Unit 6 shows you where to check.

### "I'll have to read code."

**You won't.** There's one sentence in Unit 3 that handles this.

### "I'll get stuck and waste a week."

**You won't.** Each unit takes 10 to 25 minutes. Quit after Unit 2 and you still walk away owning a live website.



# the path

8 units. Tap through them in order. Later ones unlock as you go.

START

0 **Pick what you're building**
UNIT 0 · 2 min

1 **Say your first word**
UNIT 1 · 12 min

2 **Three switches, flipped once**
UNIT 2 · 15 min

🔒 **Learn the sentence**
UNIT 3 · 25 min

🔒 **Run the loop**
UNIT 4 · 20 min

🔒 **Stop looking like every AI site**
UNIT 5 · 15 min

🔒 **Watch your hearts**
UNIT 6 · 10 min

🔒 **Your phrasebook**
UNIT 7 · 15 min

🏆 **Graduate**
UNIT 8 · 10 min



**2 hours total, spread over 7 days.**

UNIT 0 · 2 MIN

# why are you here?

Duolingo asks why you're learning Spanish before it teaches you a single word, because the answer changes the lessons. Same here. **Pick one.**

A **A landing page for my thing.** Your units: 1, 2, 3, 5. Skip 7 for now.

B **A mockup so my dev stops guessing what I meant.** Your units: 1, 3, 4, 8. Unit 8 is your whole point.

C **A tool that kills a job I hate doing.** Your units: 1, 3, 4, 7.

D **I'm curious. Don't judge me.** Do Units 1 and 2. That's 27 minutes and you'll own a website at the end of it. Decide after that.

💡 TIP

Write your answer down here: **I want** _____

You'll paste that exact sentence into Claude in Unit 3, so keep it plain. "A booking page for my coaching business" works. "A platform that revolutionises client onboarding" gets you something nobody can use.

12 MIN +20 XP

UNIT 1

# say your first word

### LESSON 1 · GET THE APP · 3 MIN

Go to **claude.com/download**, install it, and get Pro for $20 a month. Open the **Code** tab at the top.

**That's the install. All of it.**

### LESSON 2 · MAKE ONE EMPTY FOLDER · 1 MIN

One folder, on your desktop, empty. Nothing private inside it and nothing you'd cry about losing. Claude only ever touches this folder, and that's your entire safety system.

I am not going to explain how to create a folder. **I refuse.**

[ Screenshot: right click → New Folder ]

### LESSON 3 · POINT CLAUDE AT IT · 1 MIN

Click the **+**, click the little folder icon, choose your folder.

### LESSON 4 · YOUR FIRST WORD · 30 SECONDS

Type this. Exactly this.

```
make me a file called hello.txt that says hi
```

Press enter. Now open your folder.

### 🏆 CHECKPOINT

**There's a file in there and you didn't type it.** Everything else in this PDF is a bigger version of what you just did in 30 seconds.

15 MIN +30 XP

UNIT 2

# three switches you flip once, forever

### Switch 1 · Bypass permissions

Without this, Claude asks your permission before every single step, and you'll click "allow" about 30 times in one session before you give up.

**Settings, then Claude Code, then "Allow bypass permissions mode."** Now it works while you go make coffee.

Two honest notes. It's still buggy on some versions and sometimes forgets it's on, which is annoying and they'll fix it eventually. And if you're at a company, ask IT before you turn it on.

### Switch 2 · Pick your model

Bottom right. **Opus 4.8**, then **High** next to it.

Smarter models use more of your monthly allowance. On the $20 plan, stay on Sonnet for most things. Unit 6 explains when that matters.

### Switch 3 · Connect Netlify and Supabase

Both free. I am not affiliated. **Netlify** puts your site on the internet. **Supabase** holds data and logins for the day you need them.

Click **+**, then **Connectors**, then **Add connectors**. Type Netlify, click the +, authorise it with a Google account. Same for Supabase.

**You do this once. Never again.**

💡 TIP

You don't need to understand what either of those companies do. You need them connected, and that's the whole requirement.

8 MIN

UNIT 2 CHECKPOINT

# text the link to your mum

Before you learn anything else, get the payoff. Paste this:

> Build me a single web page with my name on it, one line about what I do, and a button that links to my email. Keep it clean and simple. Then use Netlify to push it live and give me a link anyone can open.

Wait. Watch it work. You'll get a link back.

🏆 CHECKPOINT

**You own a page on the internet.** Send it to one person right now, before you read on.

❤️ MISTAKES ARE FREE

It looks bad? Good, it's supposed to. Unit 5 fixes taste. The only thing this page proves is that a stranger can open a link you made without writing code.



🔥 DAY 1 COMPLETE

25 MIN +50 XP

UNIT 3 · 1 OF 2

# learn the sentence

**Unit 3 is the one that matters. If you only do one unit this week, do this one.**

There's a prompt I paste every time I open Claude Code. It's about 240 words, and if I drop all of it on you now you'll skim it and learn nothing.

So you're going to build it one tile at a time, the way Duolingo builds a sentence. Run each tile. Watch what changes.

### TILE 1 · MAKE IT SPEAK HUMAN

> You're my CTO. I'm the CEO, I don't write code, and I don't want to read it. Talk to me in plain English, only about what I can see, click, or decide. No code, no jargon.

Run it. The screen stops being frightening.

### TILE 2 · STOP IT ASKING PERMISSION

> Bypass permissions is on, so don't stop to ask me to approve technical steps. Just build it.

### TILE 3 · SAY WHAT YOU WANT TO EXIST

> I want [the sentence you wrote in Unit 0].

Describe the end result and let Claude pick the steps, because picking the steps is the actual job you're hiring it for.

### TILE 4 · MAKE IT INTERVIEW YOU

> Before you build anything, interview me. Ask me everything you need to get this right, one question at a time, using the AskUserQuestion tool so I can click my answers. Keep the questions about what it does and how it looks. Decide the technical parts yourself. When you have enough, tell me the plan in a few plain sentences, then build it.

Tile 4 does the most work of anything in this guide. You stop having to know what to ask for, because Claude asks you, and you click your answers.

UNIT 3 · 2 OF 2

# learn the sentence

**TILE 5 · PUT IT ONLINE**

> Use Netlify to push it live and give me a link anyone can open. Use Supabase for the data and add Google login, with Row Level Security on so each person only sees their own data.

Drop the second line if nobody needs to log in.

**TILE 6 · MAKE IT CHECK ITS OWN WORK**

> Build one piece at a time. After each piece, open it yourself, check it works (on a phone too) and looks right, and fix what's off before you show me. Then tell me what to look at.

Without Tile 6, Claude hands you half-broken things and you become the tester. With it, Claude tests itself first and you only see the version that already works.

## Now the whole sentence

🏆 **CHECKPOINT**

Paste all 6 tiles as one message. Add a screenshot of any site you like. Answer the questions it asks you. **Then walk away for 20 minutes.**

Mine took 24 minutes to build a full booking page, live on the internet, from this exact prompt.

💡 **TIP**

Save this prompt somewhere you'll find it again. Notes, a text file, anywhere. You'll paste it at the start of every project from now on.



🔥 DAYS 2 AND 3 COMPLETE

UNIT 4

# run the loop

Nobody gets it right first time. Not me, not developers, not anyone who tells you otherwise on LinkedIn. **The skill is the loop.**

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Look at what Claude built.** | **Write down what's wrong, in plain words, as a numbered list.** | **Paste the list back.** | **Refresh. Look again.** |

Five or six rounds per page. It's oddly satisfying.

## What a good list looks like

1. The headline is too small.
2. Move the booking button above the testimonials.
3. The photo is squashed on my phone.
4. Remove the third section entirely.

Numbered and specific. That's the whole technique.

## Stuck on something broken?

Screenshot it, paste it, type **"fix this."** Faster than describing it, every time.

❤️ MISTAKES ARE FREE

Broke something? Type "undo the last change." Broke it worse? Start a fresh chat and describe what you want again. Broke it so thoroughly that you're embarrassed? Delete the folder, make a new one, and start over. You lost 20 minutes.

**There's no button in Claude Code that costs you anything permanent, so stop hovering over things.**

🔁 PRACTICE

Go back to the page from Unit 2 and run the loop 5 times. Change the colour. Move something. Break it on purpose, then fix it.

15 MIN +30 XP

UNIT 5

# stop looking like every other AI site

Everyone is vibecoding now, so everyone's site looks the same. Here's how to fix that without touching code.

## Steal a real brand's taste

There's an open format called **DESIGN.md**: a plain text file listing exact colours, fonts, spacing and rules. Drop it in your folder, tell Claude "use this for all the styling," and the whole site comes out looking like one designer made it. You don't have to write one.

1. **Go to getdesign.md (not affiliated, it's just very cool)**
2. **Search a brand. Stripe, Notion, Airbnb, Linear, Claude itself.**
3. **Click Download DESIGN.md. Free.**
4. **Drag it into Claude Code.**

**designmd.app** has 400+ more.

## Ask for a real component library

Tell Claude: **"use shadcn/ui components."** Your buttons, menus and forms come out looking professional. It uses a lot of your monthly allowance, so save it for dashboards, SaaS apps and anything with a lot of forms.

## Start from a screenshot

Found a site you like? Screenshot it, drag it in, say **"build me this, but for my thing."** Fastest start there is.

Hunt on Dribbble, Awwwards, Godly, Land-book, Lapa Ninja, Mobbin, One Page Love.

🚫 BANNED PHRASE

Stop typing **"make it look good."** Name the font. Give the exact colours. Ask for more whitespace. Paste two references. Claude has had enough of "make it look good."



🔥 DAYS 4 AND 5 COMPLETE

10 MIN +20 XP

UNIT 6

# watch your hearts ❤️❤️❤️

Duolingo gives you hearts. Lose them all and you stop until they refill. Claude Code has the same thing, and it's called your usage. Type **/usage** in Claude Code to see where you stand.

Pro is $20 a month and it's genuinely enough to start. You do not need the expensive plan to try any of this.

But Claude Code goes through your allowance faster than a normal chat, because every message you send re-sends the whole conversation plus every file Claude has read, so a session that felt short can cost you more than an hour of chatting would.

## Five habits that keep you under the cap

1. **Start a fresh chat for every new task. This one habit does more than the other four combined.**
2. **Stay on Sonnet if you're paying $20, and only reach for Opus 4.8 High on the $100 plan.**
3. **Point Claude at your files instead of pasting big blocks of text into the chat.**
4. **Ask for a plan before any big change, so you're not paying for a wrong turn.**
5. **Don't use Claude Code for everything. ↓**

## Don't use Claude Code for everything

| IF YOU WANT: | USE: |
|---|---|
| **A small widget you'll look at once** | **An Artifact, in a normal chat** |
| **A document or a spreadsheet** | **Claude Cowork** |
| **A single image** | **ChatGPT (High)** |
| **A real project you'll put online** | **Claude Code** |

MY RULE

**Do not take longer to build it than to consume it.**

People vibecode for six hours to make a thing they open twice and abandon. That's performative productivity, and it will eat your week.

UNIT 7

# your phrasebook

**10 copy-paste prompts. Each one slots into Tile 3. Fill in the brackets.**

## A landing page

PROMPT

A landing page for my [coaching business] that sells [my group program]. Big headline, a short pitch, [3] offers with prices, a couple of testimonials, and a [booking] button. Make it feel [calm and premium], with lots of whitespace.

## A mockup for your developer

PROMPT

A clickable mockup of [the feature I keep failing to explain]: [a dashboard where my team sees who's doing what]. It doesn't have to work. I just need to show my [developer] the screens and the flow. When it's done, write a short plain-English spec of what you built so I can hand it over.

## A tool for a boring job

PROMPT

A tool that takes [my export of orders] and [turns it into a clean monthly report with totals by product]. I drop the file in, it hands me the report back. Just for me, rough edges are fine.

## An app people log into

PROMPT

A simple app where [my students] sign in with Google and see [their own progress and next lesson]. Each person only sees their own stuff. Start with [one screen], we can add more later.

## A dashboard

PROMPT

A dashboard that reads [the spreadsheet in this folder] and shows [my revenue, new clients, and refunds] as simple charts. Refresh it whenever I drop in a new file.

## A replacement for the app you overpay for

PROMPT

An internal tool that replaces [the $200/month app we use for [team scheduling]]. It only needs to do the [3] things we actually use: [list them]. Just for my team, and make it feel faster than the tool we're dropping.

*An HR lead who had never coded built her own org-chart software in 3 days and dropped a pricey vendor.*

## A tool that reads a pile of files

PROMPT

A tool that reads [every PDF in this folder] and pulls [the client name, the renewal date, and the total] into one clean spreadsheet. I drop the files in, it does the rest.

*Non-engineers pull details out of 150+ contracts in minutes this way.*

## A marketing variation machine

PROMPT

A tool where I paste [my best ad], and it gives me [10] new versions for [different audiences], keeping [my brand voice]. Put them in a simple list I can copy from.

*Anthropic's own growth marketing team turned hours of copy-pasting into one batch.*

## A sorter for your inbound

PROMPT

A tool that takes [all my [grant / job / speaker] applications] and scores each one against [my 3 criteria], then sorts them best to worst with a one-line reason for each.

*A SaaStr team auto-scores thousands of event applications.*

## The small paid product you keep thinking about

PROMPT

A small paid tool that fixes [the thing that annoys me every week]: [describe it]. Someone signs in with Google, [does the one useful thing], and pays [$9]. Keep it to one screen.



10 MIN +30 XP

UNIT 8

# graduate 🎓

At some point your thing gets real. It needs proper security for 1,000+ users, or it's about to hold other people's private data. That's when you bring in a human coder, because it's still 2026. And it will still be true in 2030.

The handoff is easy, because everything lives in that one folder. So you send the folder. **Paste this first:**

```
You're my CTO, and we're handing this project to a real developer.

Write them a handoff file called HANDOFF.md and save it in this folder.
Plain English, no fluff:
- What this app does, and who it's for.
- What's built and working, and what's still rough or unfinished.
- The stack you used (Netlify, Supabase) and where the important pieces live.
- What a developer needs before touching it: how logins work, where the data lives, any secrets or gotchas.
- The honest note: this is a prototype I built by describing it, not production code.

Keep it to a five-minute read so they can take it over fast.
```

## The honest page

Duolingo will not make you fluent in Spanish. You already knew that. This PDF will not make you a developer either.

**✓ WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO**

Build a real, live, clickable version of an idea and hand it to someone. Build a small tool that beats a chatbot for one specific job. Stop failing to explain what you meant.

**✗ WHAT YOU STILL CAN'T DO**

Ship something that holds other people's money or private data. Handle 1,000 users. Debug anything that goes properly wrong at 2am.

**Those are the limits. Knowing where they are is most of the skill.**



# COURSE COMPLETE 🎉

| 8 / 8 | 250 | 7 |
|---|---|---|
| UNITS FINISHED | XP EARNED | DAY STREAK |

## Your streak 🔥

- □ Day 1 Units 0 and 1 · You made a file without typing it
- □ Day 2 Unit 2 · You own a link on the internet
- □ Day 3 Unit 3 · You learned the sentence
- □ Day 4 Unit 3 checkpoint · You built the real thing
- □ Day 5 Units 4 and 5 · You ran the loop and gave it taste
- □ Day 6 Units 6 and 7 · You know the costs and 10 things to build
- □ Day 7 Unit 8 · You shipped it

Roughly 2 hours of your life, and there's a website on the internet with your name on it.

## Next course

Claude for Dummies · the place to start
Claude Cowork · the next level up
claude101.com · every free guide (I vibecoded that site too)

C

Claude Code · now

You haven't opened me in 3 days.
Your booking page is still sitting there.
Alone.

**🔥 7-day streak · ⚡ 250 XP · 🌐 1 site live**

Screenshot this and send it to the person who's been meaning to try Claude Code for six months and still hasn't opened it once.